



Utilization of SGS ZOOM accounts

2026-08-12

Background

Zoom is woven into the fabric of Shambhala—we navigate it daily but rarely see the full picture. SGS maintains Zoom accounts across nine distinct functions: Shambhala Online classes, Board governance, staff administration, and leadership circles (including the Code of Conduct officers and Global Community Council). An educational license keeps costs manageable, but understanding actual usage patterns reveals both the scale and surprising gaps in how we deploy this essential infrastructure.

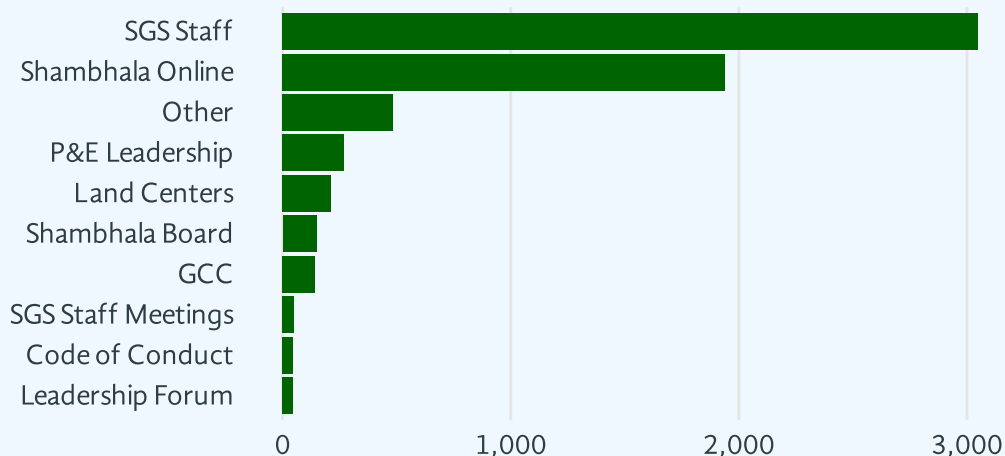
Recently, detailed records of each meeting or event held on Zoom since June 2024 have become available. Those records detail the meeting’s host, the number of participants, the event date, whether it was recorded, and its duration. All of this data can be summarized by month to get a sense of the level of activity and trends over time.

Account Distribution

Shambhala’s Zoom capacity is distributed across multiple account types, each serving a distinct mission. Some people use their own, separately purchased Zoom accounts (Faradee, Frederick, and Pawel as well as most Board members) so their activity is not reflected in this report. The breakdown below shows how demand is distributed:

Zoom Events by Account Type

Total events: 6,383

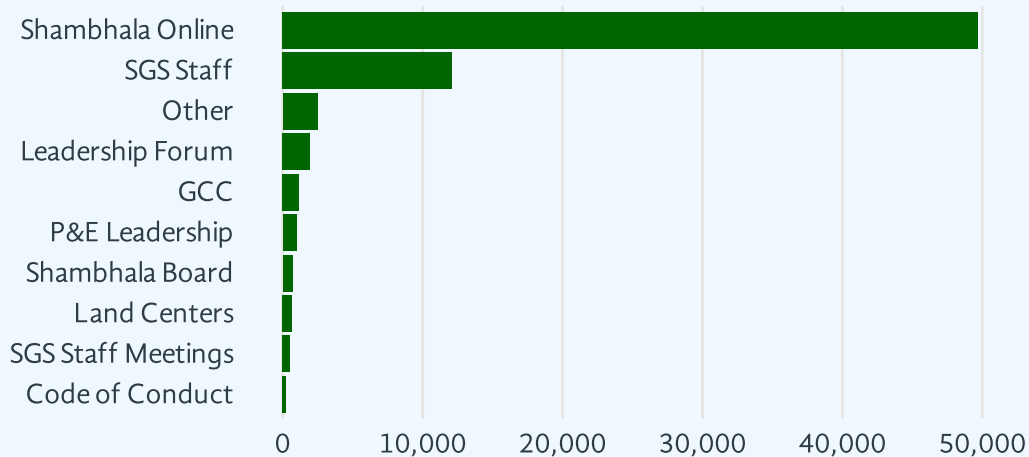


SGS Staff members are completely dependent on Zoom to do their work. On the other hand, Zoom is key for providing Shambhala Online’s services.



Zoom Participants by Account Type

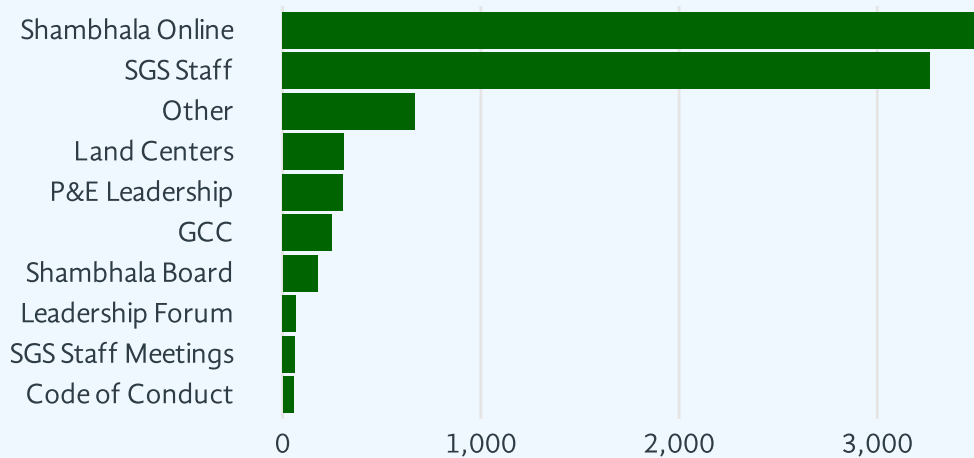
Total participants: 70,461



The picture changes when we look at the total number of participants.

Zoom Hours by Account Type

Total hours: 8,656



Total hours is the sum of meeting length for each meeting - summed over account type.



Big Events in Shambhala

Most Zoom events are small — 75% have five or fewer participants. Yet several events annually exceed our standard account limit of 300, signaling both the breadth of our community and moments when Shambhala gathers at scale.

Events with more than 300 participants		
Since 2024-06-01		
Title	Participants	Date
The Funeral Ceremony of Lady Diana Judith Mukpo	686	2025-09-17
Meditation Instructor Training: Weekends One, Two & Three	622	2025-11-15
The Funeral Ceremony of Lady Diana Judith Mukpo	568	2025-09-17
Meditation Instructor Training: Weekends One, Two & Three	480	2026-02-28
Meditation Instructor Training: Weekends One, Two & Three	465	2026-05-30
2024 Continuing Education for Meditation Instructors: Week-end Three	434	2024-06-23
The Sacred Path: Golden Key	387	2026-05-17
Meditation Instructor Training: Weekends One, Two & Three	385	2025-11-16
Leading With Authenticity, Power, and Heart	372	2026-06-21
Meditation Instructor Training: Weekends One, Two & Three	362	2026-03-01
Meditation Instructor Training: Weekends One, Two & Three	342	2026-05-31
Drala	327	2025-01-11
The Sacred Path: Golden Key	320	2026-05-16
Drala	305	2025-01-12



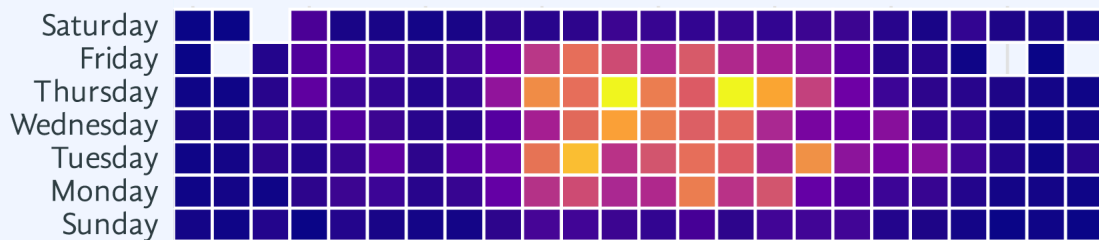
Daytime for Shambhala

Shambhala's Zoom activity reveals two distinct rhythms. The heatmap below shows when our community actually meets—a window into when Shambhala is most alive on Zoom.

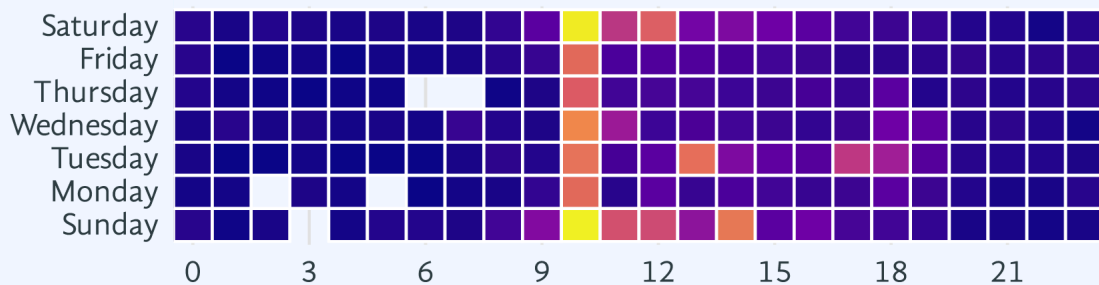
Shambhala's Zoom Events

All events between Jun 2024 and Jul 2026

Other Zoom Accounts



Shambhala Online



Hour of Day, Eastern Time

Number of
Events

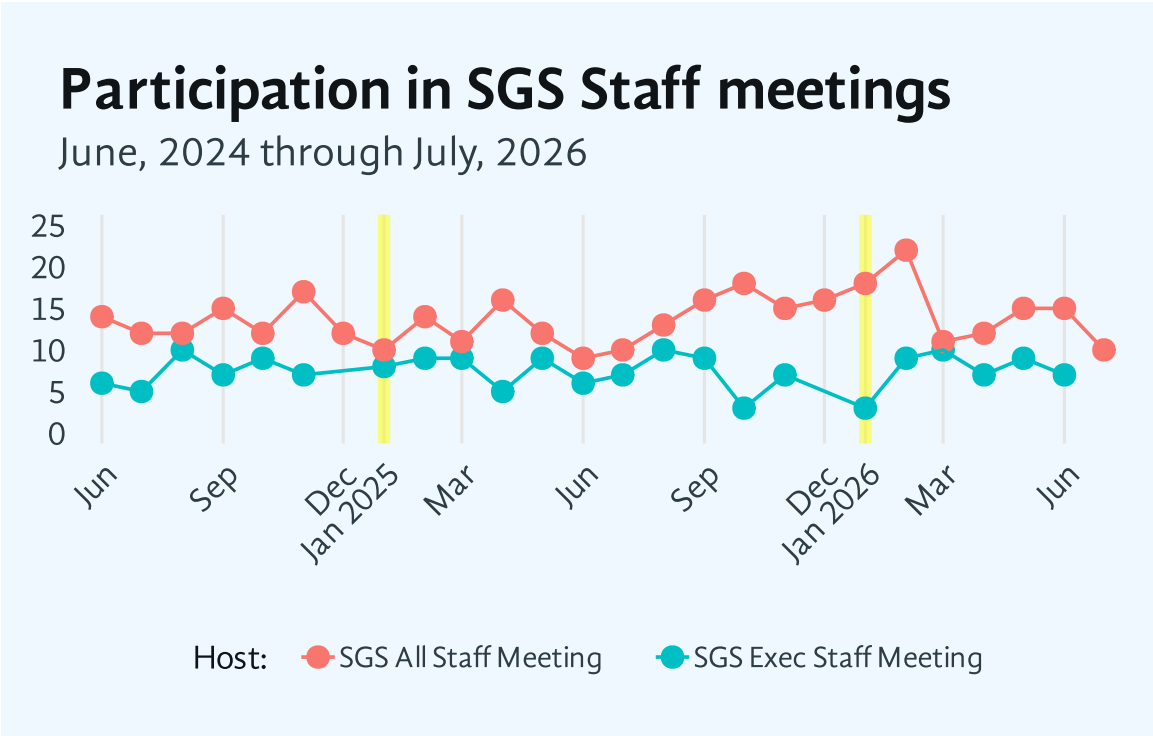


The dominance of off-peak Zoom reflects Shambhala's global reach and the role of evening practices, evening governance, and early-morning Asian participation. This also suggests that capacity during 9-to-5 is rarely our bottleneck.



Scale of ZOOM use

Staff meetings form the backbone of SGS operations. The graph below tracks participation across each month; yellow lines mark January 1st boundaries, useful for spotting seasonal patterns.

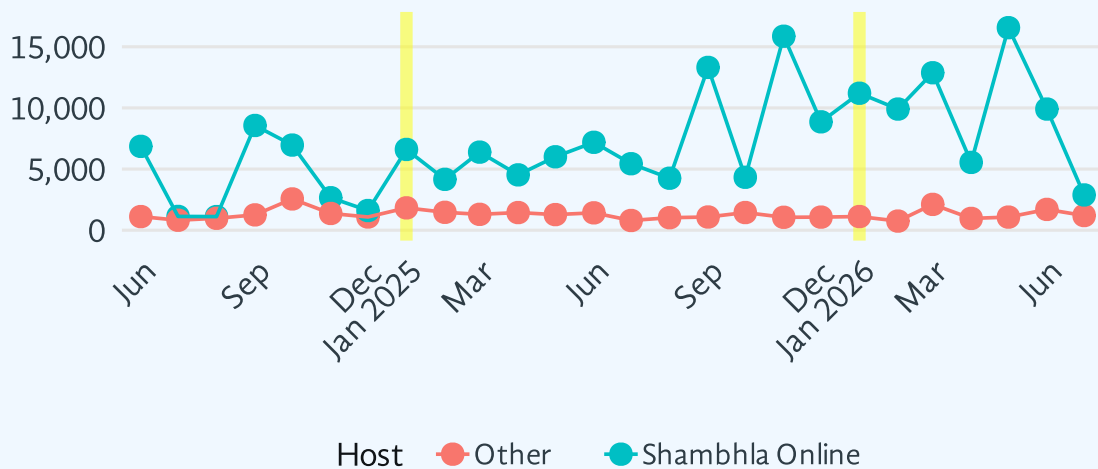


To get a sense of the scale of SGS use, look at the length of zoom meetings (in hours) multiplied by the number of participants. The data doesn't distinguish between internal use within SGS and the hours that our community as a whole spends on ZOOM in events hosted by SGS.



Monthly Hours on ZOOM

June, 2024 through July, 2026



To grasp the scale: 10,000 participant-hours in a single month equals 13 months of non-stop Zoom calls, or the energy footprint of driving 25,000–50,000 miles in an average car. And this understates the reality—many sessions are recorded and redistributed via Vimeo or Google Drive, extending their reach long after the live event ends.

Recordings

Recordings extend a meeting's life: attendees revisit content, others catch up asynchronously, and Shambhala Online distributes curated sessions via Vimeo. Yet only 10% of Zoom meetings are recorded. The constraint is financial—Zoom charges for cloud storage overages. In Q2 2025 alone, SGS spent roughly \$350 on storage, a cost that directly tracks how many recordings linger in the cloud longer than necessary.

Recently Shambhala Online in particular has established methods and protocols for offloading Zoom recordings on to Vimeo.

Scale Differences in the Use of Recordings

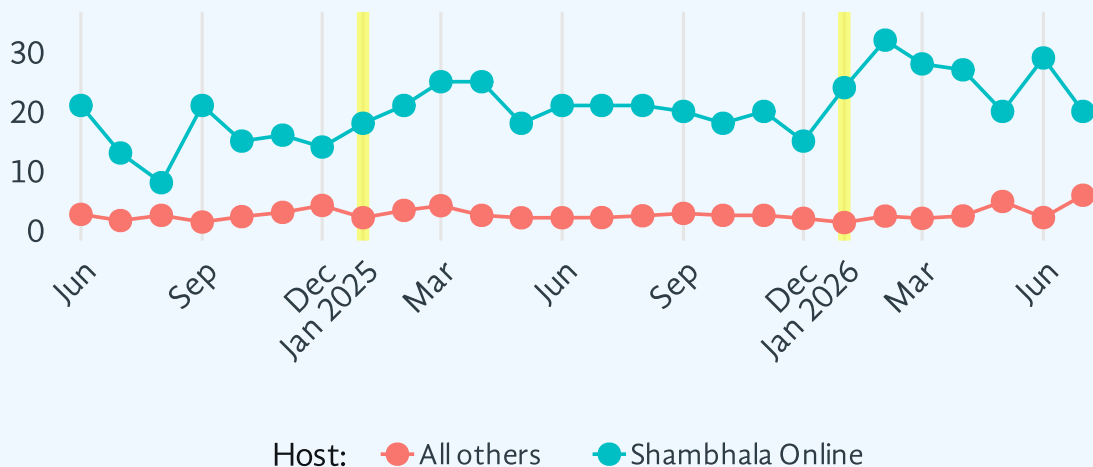
Shambhala Online operates at fundamentally different scale. Its nine accounts function as a unified ecosystem—interchangeable tools for a coherent mission. By contrast, other SGS accounts serve distinct, non-instructional purposes. The graphs below reflect this asymmetry: Shambhala Online's activity is *summed* across all nine accounts; other accounts' activity is *averaged*. The visual disparity is real, not an artifact of methodology.

In these two graphs, Shambhala Online **totals** are contrasted with **averages** for individual accounts.



Number of Recorded Events

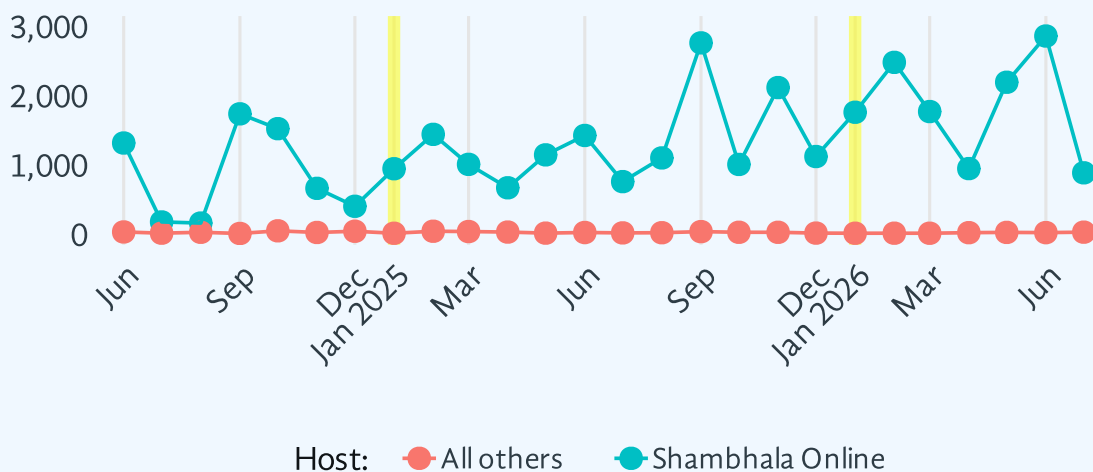
June, 2024 through July, 2026



Not only are there **more** Shambhala Online events, those events have more participants.

Participants in Recorded Events

June, 2024 through July, 2026



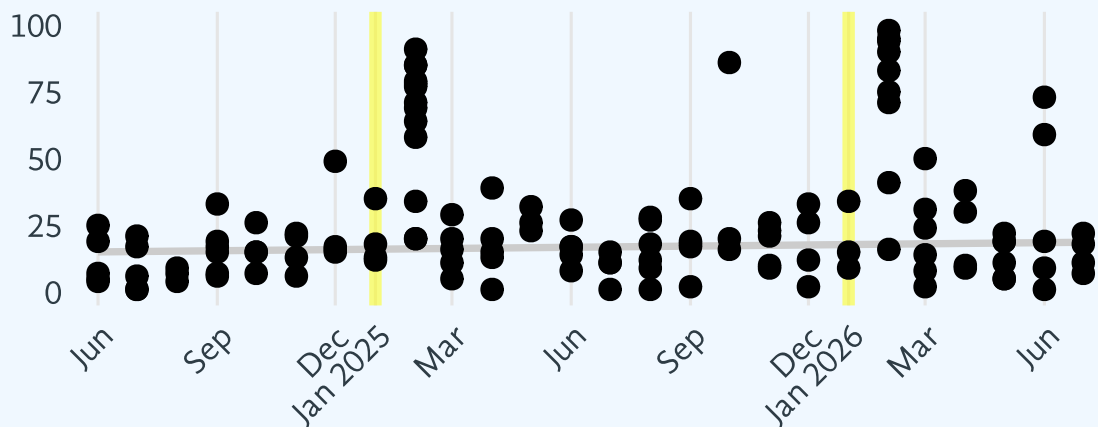


Participation in Recorded Regularly Scheduled Online Offerings

Three recurring programs reveal Shambhala's heartbeat: Sunday Gatherings (community practice), Leadership Forums (governance), and P&E calls (administration). Together they show whether participation is growing, stable, or waning.

Participation in Sunday Gatherings

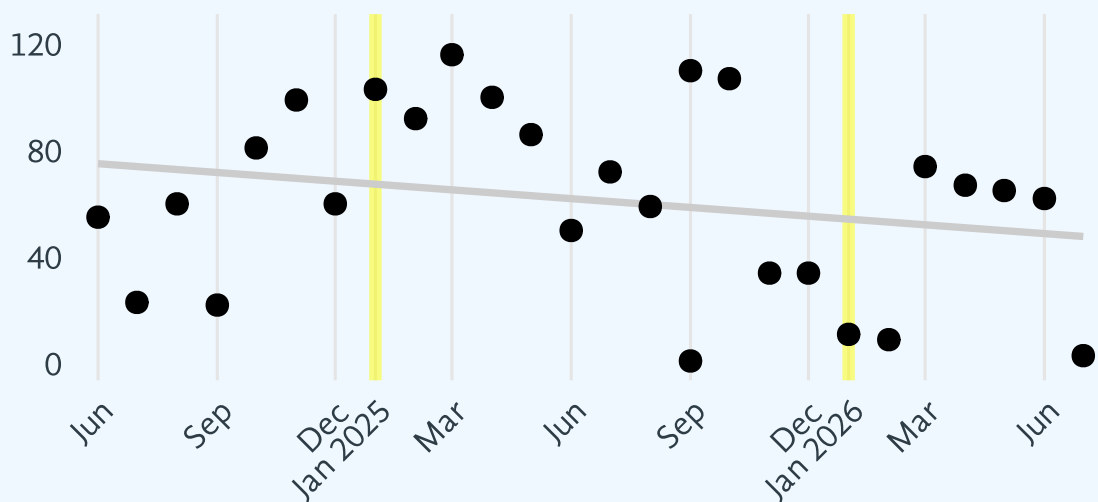
June, 2024 through July, 2026



Mamo chants before Shambhala Day are clearly a draw

Leadership Forums

June, 2024 through July, 2026





Daily Tonglen Practice

For more than a year, Shambhala has held Daily Tonglen for Ukraine every single day—a practice of heartfelt activism that stands as a remarkable testament to collective commitment. The data below documents this consistency and reveals the rhythms of a community practice.

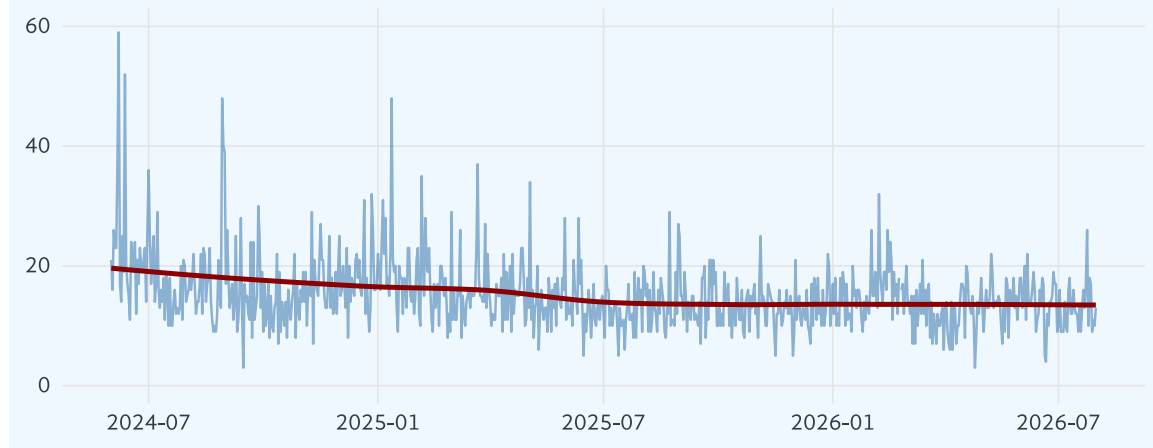
Timing Patterns

Key Statistics

Over the full period, Shambhala held 888 Daily Tonglen sessions, achieving 100% daily coverage—meaning tonglen happened on 791 of 791 possible days. Each session draws an average of 13.8 participants and runs for 76.5 minutes. This consistency, across seasons and cycles, reflects something essential about Shambhala’s character.

Daily Tonglen Participation Over Time

June 2024 - September 2025



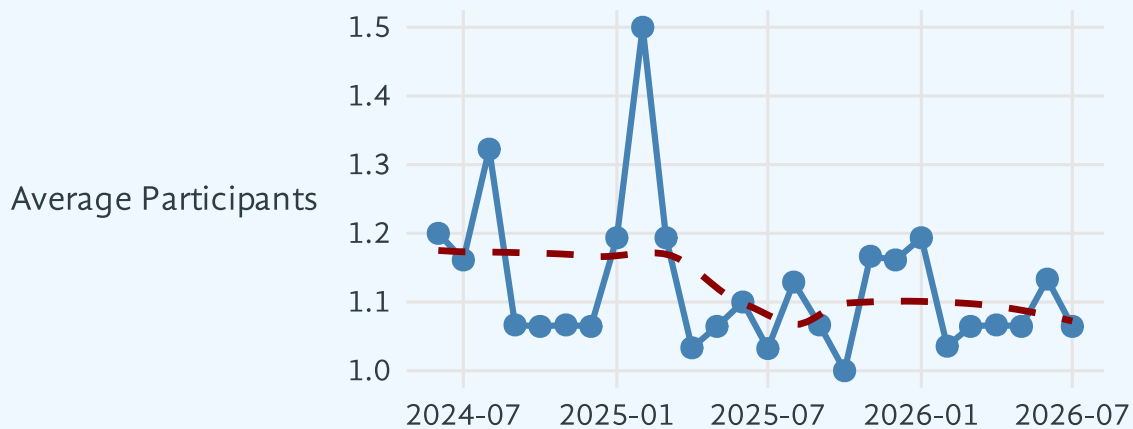
Community Stability

Daily Tonglen’s consistency is remarkable. But is the core group stable or rotating? The chart below shows how many participants show up each day:



Daily Tonglen: Active Participants per Day

Average count across all sessions in each month



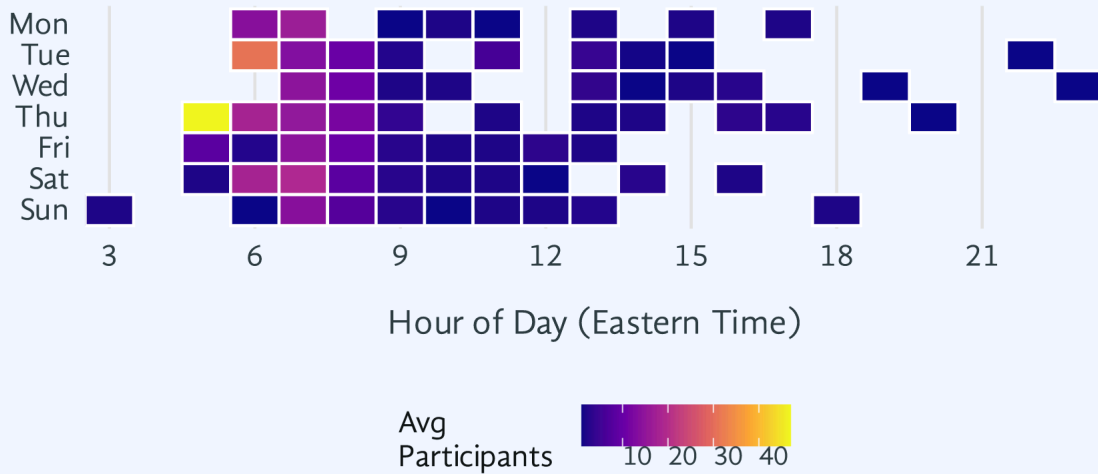
A stable line indicates a consistent core group; declining suggests turnover

The stable line indicates a committed core, not a revolving door. This stability—maintained over 15 months—is the heartbeat Shambhala should celebrate and protect.



Daily Tonglen: Preferred Times

Average participants by day of week and hour



This heatmap suggests that the account designated for Tonglen practice might be used for a variety of purposes.